

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Calc Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter **4**

Using Styles and Templates in Calc

*Bringing uniformity to your
spreadsheets*

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Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

<i>Windows/Linux</i>	<i>Mac equivalent</i>	<i>Effect</i>
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	<i>⌘+T</i>	Open Styles & Formatting window

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What is a Template?

A *template* is a model used to create other documents. For example, you can build an invoice template that places your company's logo and address at the top of the page. Therefore, new spreadsheets created from this template will all have your company's logo and address on their first page.

Templates can contain anything that regular documents can contain:

- text
- graphics
- styles
- user-specific setup information such as measurement units, language, the default printer, and toolbar and menu customization

All documents in Apache OpenOffice (AOO) are based on templates. You can create or download and install as many templates as you wish. If you do not specify a template when you start a new spreadsheet, the new spreadsheet is based on the default template for spreadsheets. If you have not specified a default template, AOO uses the blank spreadsheet template installed with AOO. See "Setting a Default Template" on page 19.

What are Styles?

A *style* is a set of formats you can apply to selected elements in a document, to control or quickly change their appearance. When you apply a style, you apply a whole group of formats simultaneously.

Many people manually format spreadsheet cells and pages without paying attention to styles. They are used to formatting documents according to *physical* attributes. For example, for the contents of a cell, you might specify the font family, font size, and any formatting, such as bold or italic.

Styles are *logical* attributes. Using styles means that you stop saying "font size 14pt, Times New Roman, bold, centered" and you start saying "Title" because you have defined the "Title" style to have those characteristics. In other words, 'styles' means shift the emphasis from what the page or other elements look like to what it *is*.

Styles help improve consistency in a document and can greatly speed up formatting. They also make major formatting changes easy. For example, you may decide to change the appearance of all subtotals in your spreadsheet to 10 pt. Arial instead of 8 pt. Times New Roman after you have created a 15-page spreadsheet, you can change all of the subtotals in the document by simply changing the properties for the subtotal style.

Page styles assist with printing, so you don't need to define margins, headers and footers, and other printing attributes each time you print a spreadsheet.

Types of Styles in Calc

While some components of AOO offer many style types, Calc offers only two:

- Cell styles include fonts, alignment, borders, background, number formats (currency, date, number), and cell protection.
- Page styles include margins, headers and footers, borders and backgrounds, the sequence for printing sheets.

Tip

The page size, orientation, and other attributes of a page style apply only when a spreadsheet is printed; they are not displayed onscreen.

Cell Styles

Like paragraph styles in AOO Writer, cell styles are the most basic type of style in Calc. When you apply a cell style to a cell, that cell will follow the formatting rules of the style. Five cell styles are supplied with AOO: Default, Heading, Heading1, Result, and Result2.

Initially, the styles are configured so that if you change the font family of *Default*, all of the other styles will change to match. We will discuss how to set this up in “Creating New (Custom) Styles” on page 12. The five standard styles can be seen in Figure 1.

	A	B
1	Default	1234.56
2	Heading	1234.56
3	<u>Result</u>	<u>1234.56</u>
4	<u>Result2</u>	<u>\$1,234.56</u>
5	Heading1	1234.56

Figure 1: Calc cell style types

Page Styles

Page styles in Calc are applied to sheets. Although one sheet may print on several printer pages, only one page style can be applied to a sheet. If a spreadsheet file contains more than one sheet, the different sheets can have different page styles applied to them. So, for example, a spreadsheet might contain one sheet to be printed in landscape orientation (using the Default page style) and another sheet to be printed in portrait orientation (using the Report page style).

Two page styles are supplied with Calc: Default and Report. You can adjust many settings using page styles. You can also define as many page styles as you wish.

Because spreadsheets are primarily used onscreen and not printed, Calc does not display the page style on the screen. If you want a spreadsheet to fit a particular page size, you can set this up on the *Sheet* tab of the Page Style dialog or using **View > Page Break Preview** and adjusting the column and row sizes.

Accessing Styles

Styles are most frequently accessed through the Styles and Formatting deck of the Sidebar or the Styles and Formatting dialog. The tools for using styles are identical in the Sidebar and the dialog, shown in Figure 2. To avoid repeating "the Sidebar deck

or the dialog," we will refer to both as the Styles and Formatting window; use whichever you prefer.

You can open the dialog in several ways.

- Keyboard: Press the *F11* key.
- Menu: Choose **Format > Styles and Formatting**.
- Toolbar: Click the  icon on the far left of the Formatting toolbar.

If the Sidebar is not visible, it can be opened with **View > Sidebar**. Once the Sidebar is visible, you can select the Styles and Formatting deck by clicking the Styles and Formatting icon .

The first button on the top left of the window, , is for cell styles, and the second, , is for page styles.

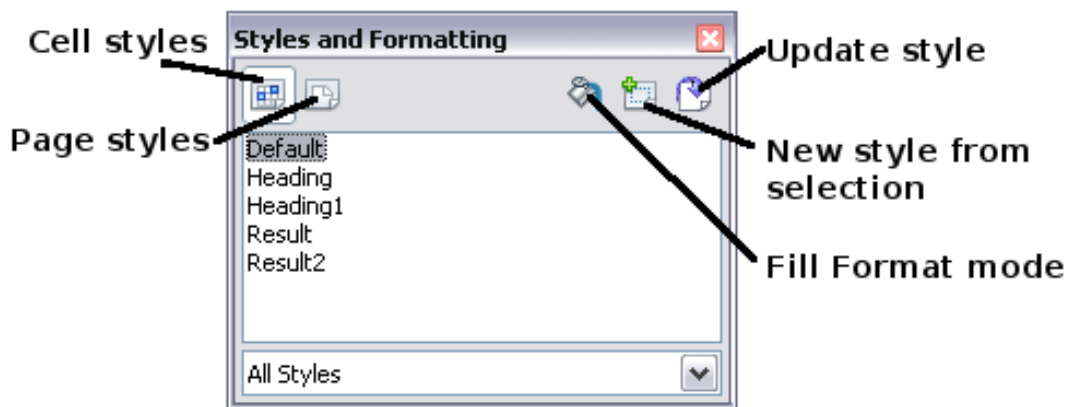


Figure 2: Styles and Formatting window

Applying Cell Styles

Calc provides several ways to apply cell styles:

- Using the Styles and Formatting window
- Using Fill Format mode
- Using the Apply Style list
- Assigning styles to shortcut keys

Using the Styles and Formatting Window

- 1) Access the Styles and Formatting window using one of the methods above.

Choose the Cell Styles list by clicking the  icon.

- 2) Highlight the cell or group of cells to which the styles should be applied.
- 3) Double-click on the cell style name.

Using Fill Format Mode

This method is quite useful for applying the same style to many scattered cells.

- 1) Open the Styles and Formatting window and select the style you want to apply.

- 2) Click the **Fill Format mode** icon . The mouse pointer changes to this icon.
- 3) Position the icon on the cell to be styled and click the mouse button.
- 4) To quit Fill Format mode, click the **Fill Format mode** icon again or close the Styles and Formatting window.

Caution



When this mode is active, a right-click anywhere in the document undoes the last Fill Format action. Be careful not to accidentally right-click and thus undo actions you want to keep.

Using the Apply Style List

You can also add an Apply Style drop-down list to the Formatting toolbar and select a style from the list to apply to the selected cells:

- 1) Click the down arrow at the right-hand end of the Formatting toolbar. On the drop-down menu, click **Visible Buttons**.

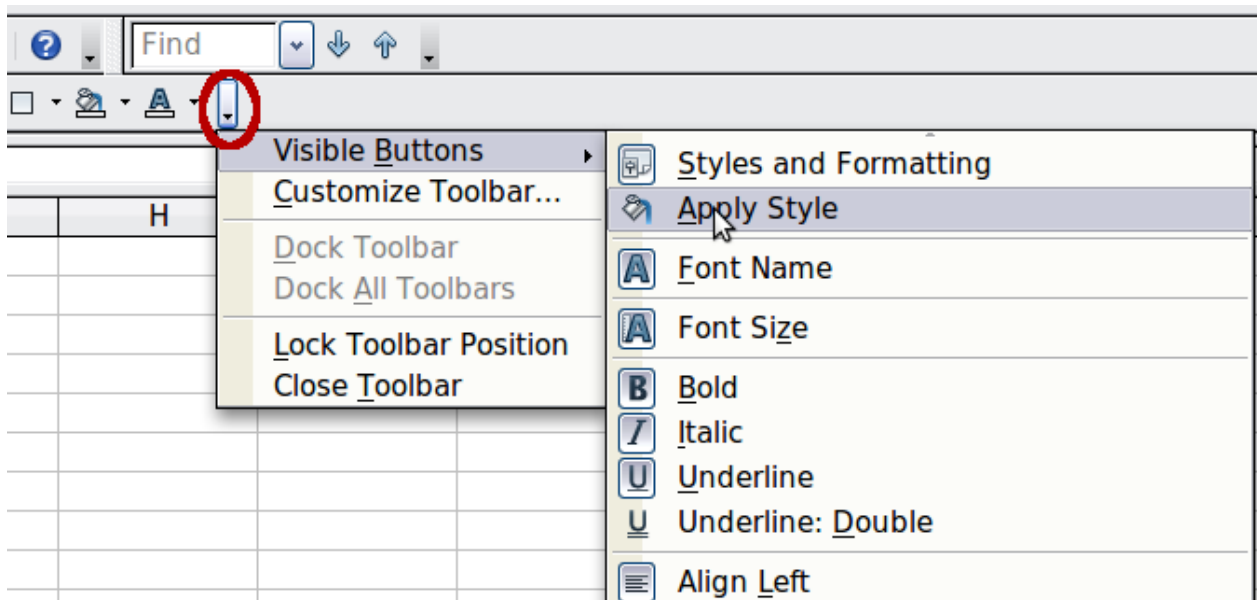


Figure 3: Adding an Apply Style list to the Formatting toolbar

- 2) On the submenu, click **Apply Style**. The menu closes, and the Apply Style list now appears on the toolbar between the Styles and Formatting icon and the Font Name list.
- 3) Select the cells to which you want to apply a style. Then select the style name from the Apply Style list.

Assigning Styles to Shortcut Keys

You can create keyboard shortcuts that can apply commonly used cell or page styles, including custom styles you have created. See Chapter 14 (Setting up and Customizing Calc) for instructions.

Applying Page Styles

- 1) Select the sheet to be styled (click on its sheet tab at the bottom of the screen).
- 2) In the Styles and Formatting window, choose the Page Styles list by clicking the  icon. Double-click on the required page style.

To find out which page style is in use for a selected sheet, look in the status bar.



Figure 4: Status bar showing location of page style information below the sheet tabs.

Modifying Styles

To modify a style, right-click on its name in the Styles and Formatting window and choose **Modify**. Make the changes in the Style dialog and click **OK** to save the changes.

You can also modify a current cell style by selecting an already-formatted cell and clicking the **Update Style** button on the top right-hand corner of the Styles and Formatting window.

Style Organizer

Right-click on the name of a style in the Styles and Formatting window. Then click **Modify** to open a Style dialog like the one shown in Figure 5.

The Style dialog has several tabs. The Organizer tab, shown in Figure 5 for cell styles, is found in all components of AOO. It provides basic information about the style. The Organizer tab for page styles is similar to the one shown for cell styles.

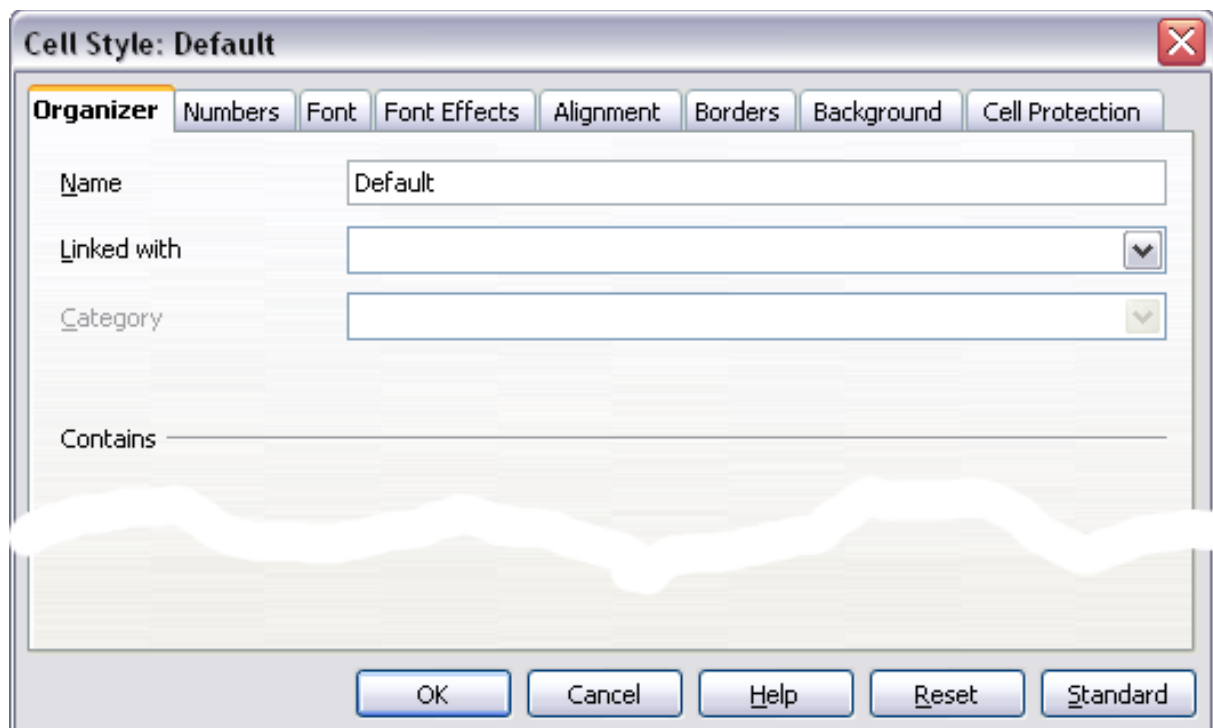


Figure 5: Organizer tab of Cell Style dialog

Name

This is the style's name. You cannot change the name of a built-in style, but you can change the name of a custom style.

Linked with

This option is only available for cell styles; page styles cannot be linked. If you link cell styles, then when you change the base style (for example, by changing the font from Times to Helvetica), all the linked styles will also change. Sometimes, this is exactly what you want; other times, you do not want the changes to apply to all the linked styles. It pays to plan ahead.

For example, you can make a new style called *red*, in which the only change you want to make is for the cell text to be red. To ensure that the rest of the text characteristics are the same as the default style, you can link *red* with *default*. Then, any changes you make to *default* will be automatically applied to *red*.

Category

In Calc, the only option in this drop-down box is Custom styles.

Cell Style Options

When editing or creating cell styles, you can set several options similar to those used for directly formatting cells. A more detailed coverage of cell formatting is given in Chapter 2 (Entering, Editing, and Formatting Data). A brief summary is provided here.

Numbers

On the *Numbers* tab, you can control the behavior of the data in a cell with this style. This includes specifying the type of data, the number of decimal places, and the language.

Font

Use the *Font* tab to choose the font for the cell's contents.

Font Effects

The *Font Effects* tab offers more font options, including underlining, strikethrough, and color.

Alignment

Use the *Alignment* tab to set the horizontal and vertical alignment for the data in the cells and rotate the text.

Borders

Use the *Borders* tab to set the borders for the cells, along with a shadow.

Background

Use the *Background* tab to choose the background color for a cell.

Cell Protection

Use the *Cell Protection* options to protect cells against certain types of editing. The cell protection is only in effect when the sheet is also protected with **Tools > Protect Document > Sheet**.

Page Style Options

Several of the page style options are described in more detail in Chapter 6 (Printing, Exporting, and E-mailing) because manually formatting a sheet at print time (using **Format > Page**) actually modifies the page style.

Page

Use the *Page* tab to edit the overall appearance of the page and its layout. The available options are shown in Figure 6.

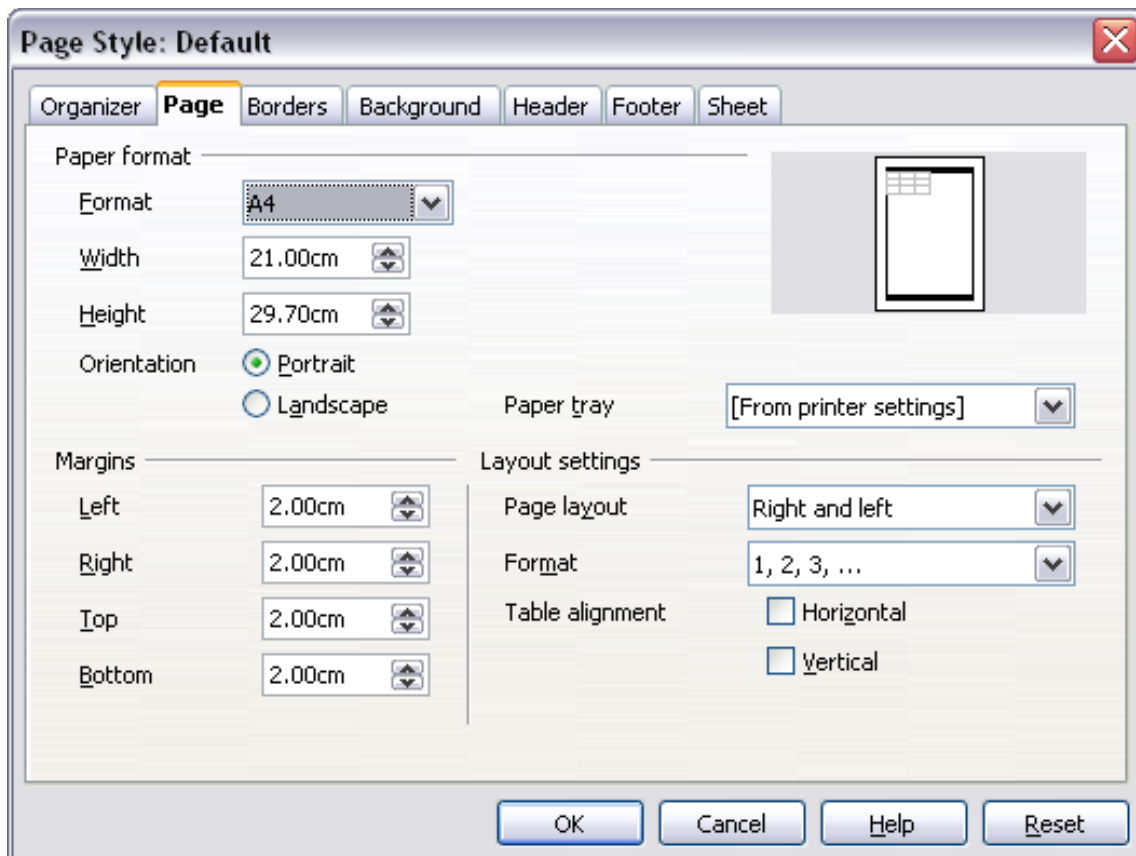


Figure 6: Page Style: Page tab

Paper format

Here, you can set a generic paper type to be used. Letter or A4 are the most commonly used, but you can also try legal, tabloid, envelope sizes, or user-defined paper types. In addition, you can define the orientation of the page and which print tray the paper will come from, if your printer has more than one tray.

Margins

This allows you to set the margins for the page.

Layout settings: Page layout

Here you can specify whether to apply the formatting to right (odd) pages only, left (even) pages only, or both right and left pages that use the current page style.

Mirrored formats the pages as if you want to bind the printed pages like a book.

The first page of a document is assumed to be an odd page.

Layout settings: Format

This area specifies the page numbering style for this page style.

Layout settings: Table alignment

This option specifies the alignment options for the cells on a printed page, either horizontal or vertical.

Borders

The Border and Background tabs for pages duplicate the tabs of the same name on cell styles and are overridden by the cell style or manual settings. You may ignore the Border and Background tabs altogether in page styles. Both tabs are illustrated with helpful diagrams.

As with formatting a cell style, we can use the Borders tab to choose whether the page should have borders, how large they should be, and how far the text will be from them.

Background

Use this tab to specify the background for this page style. You can apply either a solid color or a picture as a background.

Header

Use this tab to design and apply the header for this page style. For more detailed instructions on formatting the header, see Chapter 6 (Printing, Exporting, and E-mailing).

Footer

Use this tab to design and apply the footer for this page style. For more detailed instructions on how to format the footer, see Chapter 6.

Sheet

By far, the most important settings for Calc page styles are on the Sheet tab. Although the Sheet tab includes an option that sets the first page option, most of its settings involve exactly how your spreadsheet will print. See Chapter 6.

Creating New (Custom) Styles

You may want to add some new styles. You can do this in two ways:

- Creating a new style using the Style dialog
- Creating a new style from a selection

Note

New styles apply only to this document; they are not saved in the template. To save new styles in a template, see “Copying and Moving Styles” on page 13 and “Creating a Template” on page 16.

Creating a New Style Using the Style Dialog

To create a new style using the Style dialog, right-click in the Styles and Formatting window and choose **New** from the pop-up menu.

(Cell styles only) If you want your new style to be linked with an existing style, select that style, right-click, and choose **New**.

Tip

If you link styles, when you change the base style (for example, by changing the font from Times to Helvetica), all the linked styles will change as well. Sometimes this is exactly what you want; at other times you don't want the changes to apply to all the linked styles. It pays to plan ahead.

The dialogs and choices are the same for defining new styles and for modifying existing styles.

Creating a New Style from a Selection

You can create a new cell style by copying an existing manual format.

- 1) Open the Styles and Formatting window and choose the type of style you want to create.
- 2) Select the formatted cell in the document you want to save as a style.
- 3) In the Styles and Formatting window, click on the **New Style from Selection** icon .
- 4) In the Create Style dialog, type a name for the new style. The list shows the names of existing custom styles of the selected type. Click **OK** to save the new style.

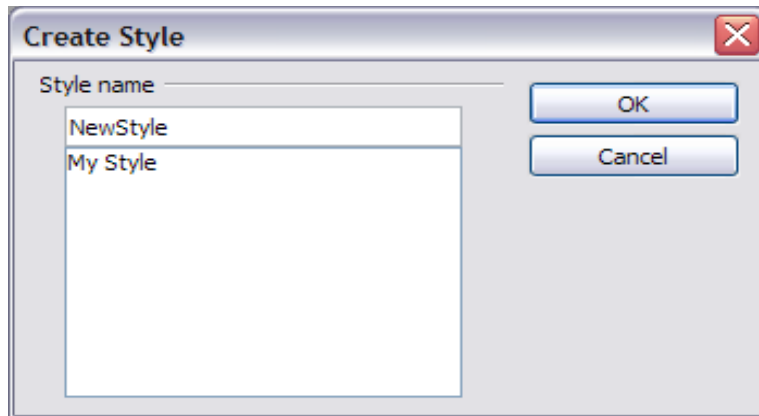


Figure 7: Naming a new style created from a selection

Creating a New Style by Dragging and Dropping

Select a cell and drag it to the Styles and Formatting window.

Copying and Moving Styles

Use the Template Management dialog to copy a style from one spreadsheet to another or between a spreadsheet and a template instead of recreating it in the second spreadsheet.

- 1) Click **File > Templates > Organize**.
- 2) In the Template Management dialog (Figure 8), set the lists at the bottom to either Templates or Documents, as needed. The default is Templates on the left and Documents on the right.

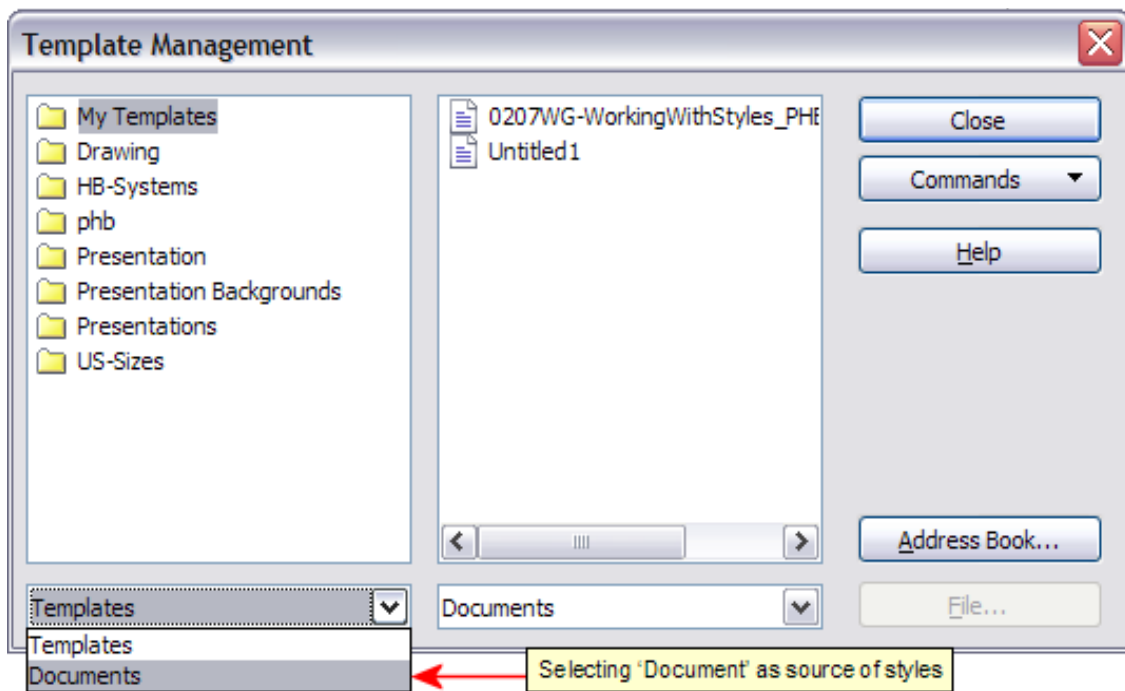


Figure 8: Choosing to copy styles from a document, not a template.

Tip To copy styles from a file that is not open, click the **File** button. When you return to this dialog, both lists show the selected file and all currently open documents.

- 3) Open the folders and find the templates from and to which you want to copy. Double-click on the template or document name, then double-click the Styles icon to show the list of individual styles (Figure 9).

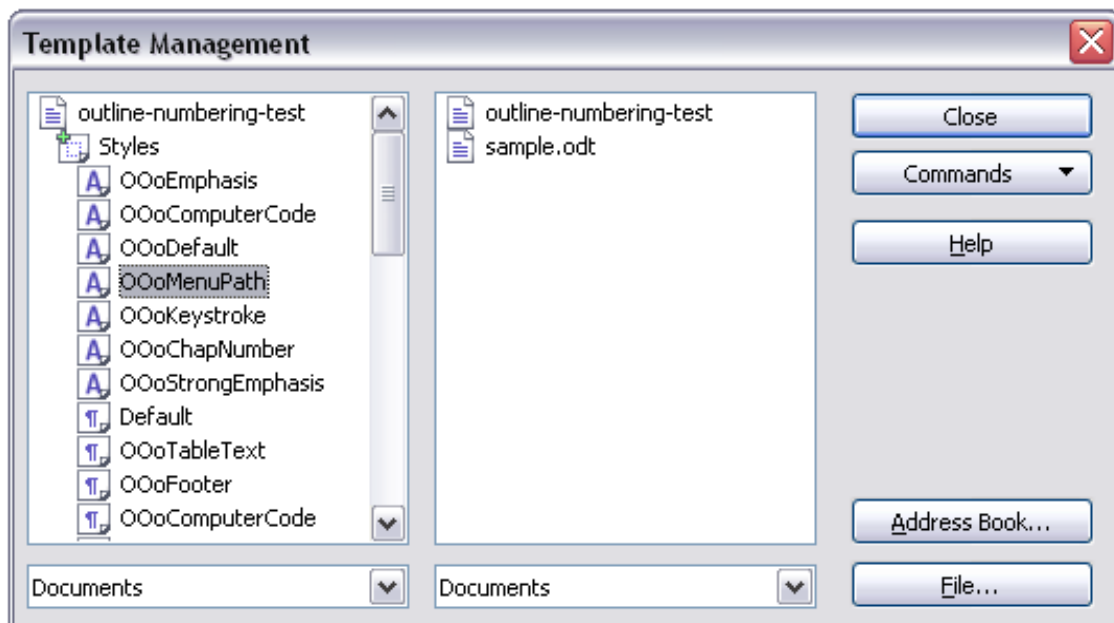


Figure 9: Copying a style from one document to another.

- 4) To *copy* a style, hold down the **Ctrl** key and drag the name of the style from one list to the other.

- 5) Repeat these steps for each style you want to copy. If the receiving template or document has many styles, you may have to scroll down the list to find a specific item. When you are finished, click **Close**.

Deleting Styles

You cannot remove (delete) any of Calc's predefined styles, even if you are not using them. However, you can remove any user-defined, custom styles. Before you do, be sure the styles in question are not in use. If an unwanted style is in use, replace it with a substitute.

Replacing styles, and then deleting the unwanted ones, can be very useful if you're dealing with a spreadsheet that several people have worked on.

To delete unwanted styles, right-click on them, *one at a time*, in the Styles and Formatting window. Then click **Delete** on the pop-up menu. Choose **Yes** in the confirmation pop-up.

Creating a Spreadsheet from a Template

To create a spreadsheet from a template:

- 1) From the main menu, choose **File > New > Templates and Documents**. The Templates and Documents dialog opens.

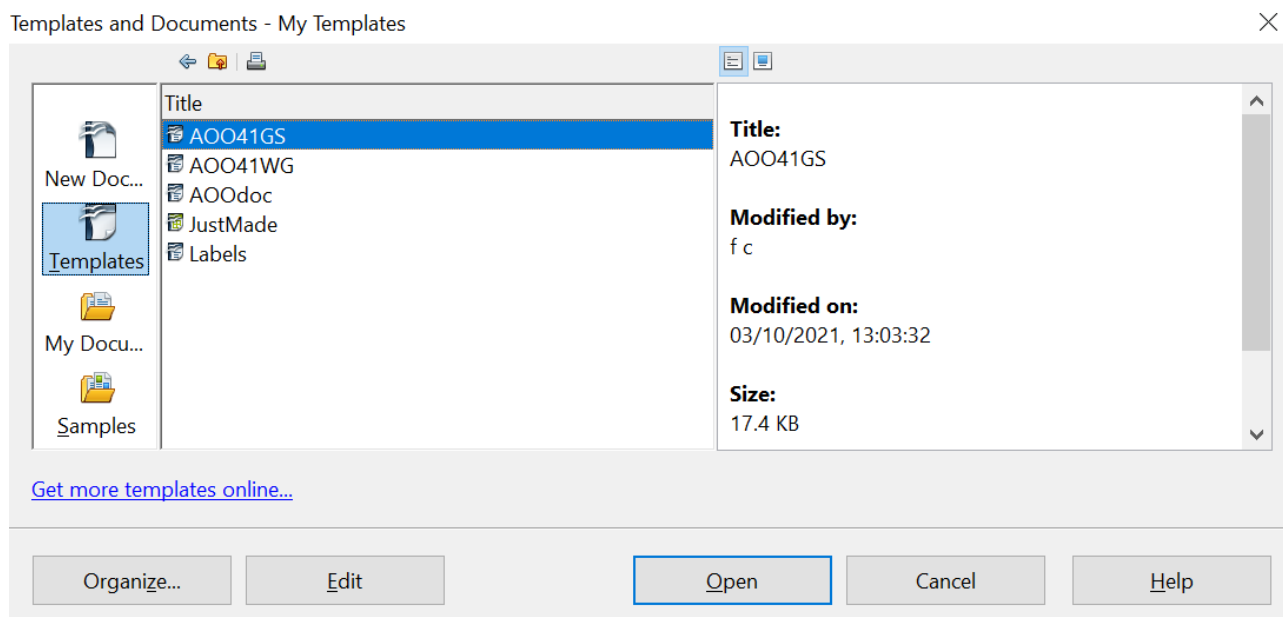


Figure 10: Templates and Documents dialog

- 2) In the box on the left, click the **Templates** icon if it has not already been selected. A list of template folders appears in the center box.
- 3) Double-click the folder holding the template you want to use. A list of all templates contained in that folder appears in the center box.
- 4) Select the template that you want to use. You can preview the selected template or view the template's properties:
 - To preview the template, click the **Preview** icon. A preview of the template appears in the box on the right.

- To view the template's properties, click the **Document Properties** icon. The template's properties appear in the box on the right.
- 5) Click **Open**. The Templates and Documents dialog closes, and a new document based on the selected template opens in Calc. You can then edit and save the new document as you would any other document.

Creating a Template

You can create a template from a document.

- 1) Open a new or existing document of the type you want to make into a template (text document, spreadsheet, drawing, presentation).
 - 2) Add the content and styles that you want.
 - 3) From the main menu, choose **File > Templates > Save**. The Templates dialog opens.
 - 4) In the **New template** field, type a name for the new template.
 - 5) In the **Categories** list, click the category to which you want to assign the template. The category you choose does not affect the template itself; it is simply the folder in which you save the template. Choosing an appropriate folder (category) makes it easier to find the template when you want to use it. You may wish to create a folder for Calc templates.
- To learn more about template folders, see "Organizing Templates" on page 21.
- 6) Click **OK** to save the new template.

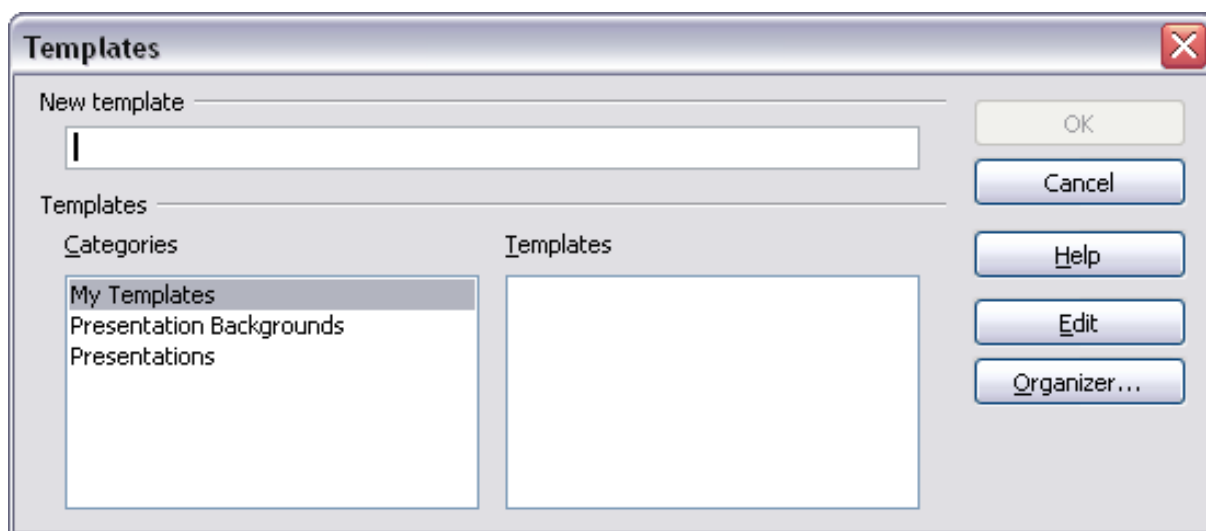


Figure 11: Saving a new template

Any settings that can be added to or modified in a document can be saved in a template. For example, below are some of the settings (although not a full list) that can be included in a Calc document and then saved as a template for later use:

- Printer settings: which printer, single-sided / double-sided, paper size, and so on
- Cell and page styles to be used

Templates can also contain predefined text, saving you from having to type it every time you create a new document. For example, an invoice template might contain your company's name, address, and logo.

You can also save menu and toolbar customizations in templates; see Chapter 14 (Setting up and Customizing Calc) for more information.

Editing a Template

You can edit a template's styles and content, and then, if you wish, you can reapply the template's styles to documents created from that template.

Note You can only reapply styles. You cannot reapply content.

To edit a template:

- 1) From the main menu, choose **File > Templates > Organize**. The Template Management dialog opens.

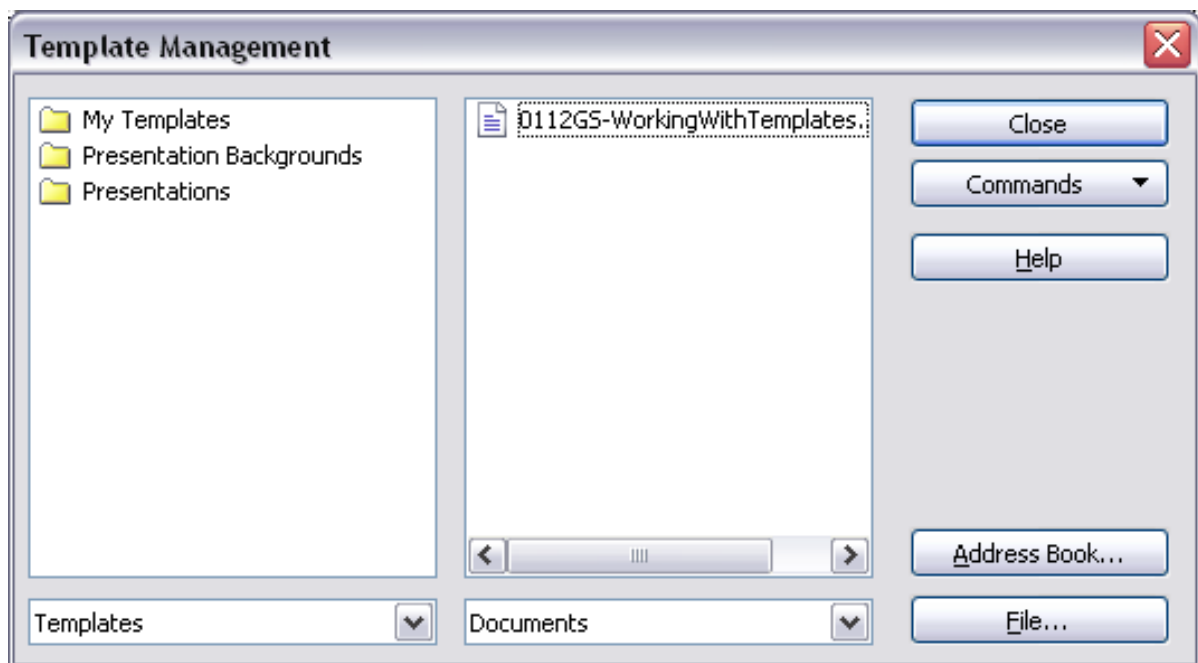


Figure 12: Template management dialog

- 2) In the box on the left, double-click the folder containing the template that you want to edit. A list of all the templates contained in that folder appears underneath the folder name.
- 3) Select the template that you want to edit.
- 4) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Edit** from the drop-down menu.
- 5) Edit the template just as you would any other document. To save your changes, choose **File > Save** from the main menu.

Updating a Spreadsheet from a Changed Template

The next time you open a spreadsheet created from the changed template, a message similar to the following appears.

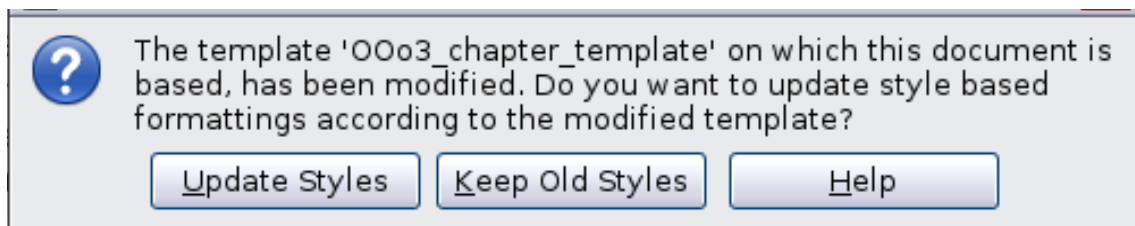


Figure 13: Update styles message

Click **Update Styles** to apply the template's changed styles to the spreadsheet. Click **Keep Old Styles** if you do not want to apply the template's changed styles to the spreadsheet (see Caution notice below).

Caution



If you choose **Keep Old Styles** in the message box shown in Figure 13, that message will not appear again the next time you open the document after changing the template it is based on. You will not get another chance to update the styles from the template, although you can use the macro given in the Note below to re-enable this feature.

Note

To re-enable updating from a template:

- 1) Use **Tools > Macros > Organize Macros > OpenOffice Basic**. Select the document from the list, click the expansion symbol (+ or triangle), and select **Standard**. If **Standard** has an expansion symbol beside it, click that and select a module.
- 2) If the **Edit** button is active, click it. If the **Edit** button is not active, click **New**.
- 3) In the Basic window, enter the following:

```
Sub FixDocV3
' set UpdateFromTemplate
oDocSettings = ThisComponent.createInstance( _
    "com.sun.star.document.Settings" )
oDocSettings.UpdateFromTemplate = True
End Sub 'FixDocV3
```

- 4) Click the **Run BASIC** icon, then close the Basic window.
- 5) Save the document.

Next time when you open this document, you will have the update from template feature back.

Adding Templates Using the Extension Manager

The Extension Manager provides an easy way to install collections of templates, graphics, macros, or other add-ins that have been “packaged” into files with a .OXT extension. See Chapter 14 (Setting Up and Customizing Calc) for more about the Extension Manager.

This Web page lists many of the available extensions: <https://extensions.openoffice.org/>.

To install an extension, follow these steps:

- 1) Download an extension package and save it anywhere on your computer.
- 2) In AOO, choose **Tools > Extension Manager** from the menu bar. In the Extension Manager dialog, click **Add**.
- 3) A file browser window opens. Find and select the package of templates you want to install and click **Open**. The package begins installing. You may be asked to accept a license agreement.
- 4) When the package installation is complete, the templates are available for use through **File > New > Templates and Documents**, and the extension is listed in the Extension Manager.

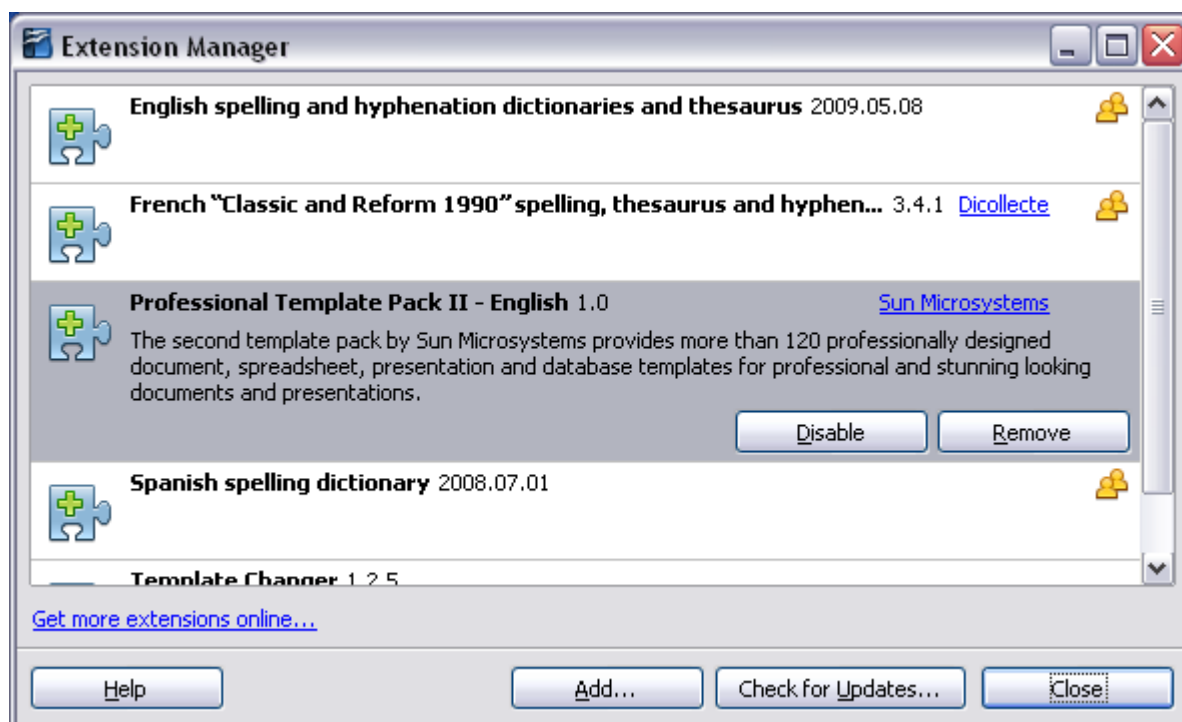


Figure 14: Newly-added package of templates

Setting a Default Template

If you create a document by choosing **File > New > Spreadsheet** from the main menu, AOO creates the document from the Default template for spreadsheets. You can, however, set a custom template as the default; you can reset the default later if you choose.

Setting a Custom Template as the Default

You can set any template as the default as long as it is in one of the folders displayed in the Template Management dialog.

To set a custom template as the default:

- 1) From the main menu, choose **File > Templates > Organize**. The Template Management dialog opens.
- 2) In the box on the left, select the folder containing the template you want to set as the default, then select the template.
- 3) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Set As Default Template** from the drop-down menu.

The next time you create a document by choosing **File > New**, the document will be created from this template.

Resetting the Default Template

To re-enable AOO's default template for a document type as the default:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, click any folder in the box on the left.
- 2) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Reset Default Template > Spreadsheet** from the drop-down menu.

The next time you create a spreadsheet by choosing **File > New**, it will be created from AOO's default template for spreadsheets.

Associating a Spreadsheet with a Different Template

Sometimes, you might want to associate a spreadsheet with a different template. Or perhaps you're working with a spreadsheet that did not start from a template, but you now want it associated with one.

One significant advantage of using templates is ease of updating styles in multiple documents, as described on page 18. If you update styles by copying them from a different template (as described on page 13), the document has no association with the template from which the styles were loaded—so you cannot use this method. What you need to do is to associate the document with a different template.

For best results, the styles' names should be the same as those in the existing document and the new template. If they are not, you will need to use Search and Replace to replace the old styles with new ones. See Chapter 2 (Entering, Editing, and Formatting Data) for more about replacing styles using Find and Replace.

- 1) Use **File > New > Templates and Documents**. Choose the template you want. A new file, based on the template, opens. If the template contains unwanted text or graphics, delete them.
- 2) Open the spreadsheet you want to change. (It opens in a new window.) Press **Control+A** to select everything in the spreadsheet.
- 3) Switch to the window containing the blank spreadsheet created in Step 1, and paste the content into that spreadsheet.
- 4) Save the file under a new name.

Organizing Templates

AOO can only use templates that are in AOO template folders. You can create new AOO template folders and use them to organize your templates, and import templates into those folders. For example, you might have one template folder for report templates and another for letter templates. You can also export templates.

To begin, choose **File > Templates > Organize** from the main menu. The Template Management dialog opens.

Note

All the actions made by the **Commands** button in the Template Management dialog can be made as well by right-clicking on the templates or the folders.

Creating a Template Folder

To create a template folder:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, click any folder.
- 2) Click the **Commands** button and choose **New** from the drop-down menu. A new folder called *Untitled* appears.
- 3) Type a name for the new folder, and then press *Enter*. AOO saves the folder with the name that you entered.

Deleting a Template Folder

You cannot delete template folders supplied with AOO or installed using the Extension Manager. You can only delete template folders that you have created.

To delete a template folder:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, select the folder you want to delete.
- 2) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Delete** from the drop-down menu. A message box will appear asking you to confirm the deletion. Click **Yes**.

Moving a Template

To move a template from one template folder to another template folder:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, double-click the folder that contains the template you want to move. A list of the templates contained in that folder appears underneath the folder name.
- 2) Click the template you want to move and drag it to the desired folder. If you do not have the authority to delete templates from the source folder, this action *copies* the template instead of moving it, leaving it in its original folder and placing a copy in the new folder.

Deleting a Template

You cannot delete templates supplied with AOO or installed using the Extension Manager. You can only delete templates that you have created or imported.

To delete a template:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, double-click the folder containing the template you want to delete. A list of the templates in that folder appears underneath the folder name.

- 2) Click the template that you want to delete.
- 3) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Delete** from the drop-down menu. A message box will appear asking you to confirm the deletion. Click **Yes**.

Importing a Template

If the template that you want to use is in a different location, you must import it into an AOO template folder.

To import a template into a template folder:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, select the folder into which you want to import the template.
- 2) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Import Template** from the drop-down menu. A standard file browser window opens.
- 3) Find and select the template you want to import, then click **Open**. The file browser window closes, and the template appears in the selected folder.
- 4) If you like, type a new name for the template and then press *Enter*.

Exporting a Template

To export a template from a template folder to another location:

- 1) In the Template Management dialog, double-click the folder that contains the template you want to export. A list of the templates contained in that folder appears underneath the folder name.
- 2) Click the template that you want to export.
- 3) Click the **Commands** button and choose **Export Template** from the drop-down menu. The Save As window opens.
- 4) Find the folder into which you want to export the template. Then click **Save**.